JAMES JOHNSTON

Entry-Level IT Candidate | Web Developer | Digital Creative

Kenilworth, Cape Town, South Africa
Email: jaston2706@gmail.com | Phone: 069 137 9046
LinkedIn: www.linkedin.com/in/james-johnston-ab2a412b3
GitHub: github.com/james-johnston-49
Portfolio Website:

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I'm an aspiring front-end developer and UI designer currently completing technical training through Life Choices Academy's YouthCode programme. I'm competent in HTML, CSS, JavaScript, Vue.js, MySQL, and Figma, with practical experience contributing to collaborative web development projects and database-driven applications. I combine technical problem-solving with a strong creative background in interface design, digital illustration, and visual storytelling. I'm interested in creating intuitive, visually engaging digital experiences and I'm eager to contribute to a technical or development team while continuing to grow professionally.

CORE SKILLS

Technical Skills

- Front-End Development: HTML5, CSS3, JavaScript, Vue.js
- UI Design & Prototyping: Figma
- Databases: MySQL, Database Integration
- Back-End Development: Node.js, Express.js, REST API Development
- Version Control: Git, GitHub
- Additional Programming Languages: PHP, Python

Creative Skills

- User Interface Design
- Visual Prototyping
- Digital Illustration and Comic Production
- Character Design and Visual Storytelling
- Creative Problem-Solving

Soft Skills

- Teamwork and Collaboration
- Time Management
- Communication

- Adaptability and Continuous Learning
- Critical Thinking
- Attention to Detail

EDUCATION & TRAINING

YouthCode Programme
Life Choices Academy | April 2026 – September 2026

A four-phase technical training programme focused on developing practical skills in information technology, web development, database management, back-end development, and e-commerce.

Programme Modules

- Module 1: Foundation – Introduction to ICT
- Module 2: Front-End Development
- Module 3: Database and Back-End Development
- Module 4: E-Commerce

Technologies Covered: HTML, CSS, JavaScript, Vue.js, Node.js, MySQL, PHP, and Python.

Certification: Certificate of Programme Completion

Cisco Networking Academy – Additional Training

- Introduction to Cybersecurity – Certificate of Completion
- Introduction to Data Science – Certificate of Completion

Livingstone High School
National Senior Certificate (Matric) | 2025

Academic Achievements

- Certificate of Conscientiousness in English.
- Certificate of Conscientiousness in Life Orientation.
- Certificate of Conscientiousness in Life Sciences.

PROJECT EXPERIENCE

GigBridge – Freelance Services Platform
Technologies: HTML5, CSS3, JavaScript | UI Design: Figma

GitHub: https://github.com/leratoyapi/lca-gigbridge-startup-launch

Live Link: https://leratoyapi.github.io/lca-gigbridge-startup-launch/

- Contributed to the visual design of a dual-sided freelance platform connecting early-career talent with small businesses.
- Created Figma designs to establish the platform's visual direction and interface layout.
- Maintained consistent CSS styling and visual cohesion across multiple pages.
- Contributed to creating a user-focused interface designed to help emerging talent gain practical experience and build professional portfolios.

ModernTech Solutions – HR Management Portal
Technologies: HTML5, CSS3, JavaScript, Node.js, Express.js, MySQL, Bootstrap, Chart.js | UI Design: Figma

GitHub: https://github.com/chefmanie27-pixel/project-modern-tech-solutions-

Live Link: https://roaring-fenglisu-d675db.netlify.app/

- Developed the dashboard interface and supporting API endpoints for an HR management portal designed to centralise employee management and HR processes.
- Implemented data aggregation endpoints providing key performance indicators for employee numbers, payroll, leave requests, and attendance.
- Created interactive dashboard visualisations for attendance, departmental headcount, and payroll trends using Chart.js.
- Developed the Performance Reviews page and supporting API functionality for viewing review history and submitting new performance reviews.
- Contributed to Figma designs and collaborated with team members on integrating front-end interfaces with back-end services.

JAM'N – Music Discovery and E-Commerce Platform
Project Technologies: Vue.js, MySQL, HTML5, CSS3, JavaScript | UI Design: Figma

GitHub: https://github.com/totoseahlumile-dot/JAM-N

Live Link: https://jamn-two.vercel.app/

- Designed Figma mockups and developed front-end interfaces for a community-driven music discovery and multi-vendor e-commerce platform focused on independent South African artists.
- Developed the Discovery, Library, Beat Store, Account, Settings, and User Profiles pages using Vue.js, HTML5, CSS3, and JavaScript.
- Contributed to the platform's visual design and user experience, supporting music discovery, artist engagement, and direct-to-fan commercial opportunities.

CREATIVE EXPERIENCE

Comic Strip Collaborator – The Newspaper Comic Strip Series
Independent Creative Collaboration | January 2026 – Present

- Illustrate comic strips based on stories written by Hunter Reynolds, translating written concepts into visual narratives.
- Contribute to character design and visual development.
- Suggest minor script adjustments to strengthen visual storytelling and improve the flow of scenes across comic panels.
- Collaborate creatively while maintaining consistency with the writer's established characters and story direction.